

Official Guidelines and Precautions for MPOX (Monkeypox)

Tuesday, September 10, 2024 9:51 AM

Issued by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

MPOX, commonly known as Monkeypox, is a viral zoonotic disease that can spread from animals to humans and between humans. The Government has issued the following rules and regulations to help mitigate the spread of the virus and protect public health.

1. Reporting and Notification

- All healthcare facilities must promptly report any suspected or confirmed cases of MPOX to the nearest public health authorities.
- Individuals experiencing symptoms of MPOX such as fever, rash, swollen lymph nodes, or flu-like symptoms should immediately contact local healthcare providers for testing and isolation advice.

2. Isolation and Quarantine

- Individuals who have tested positive for MPOX or show symptoms must isolate for at least 21 days from the onset of symptoms or until cleared by a healthcare professional.
- Close contacts of confirmed cases must quarantine for a minimum of 14 days and undergo regular health monitoring.

3. Vaccination and Immunization

- Priority vaccination is recommended for individuals in high-risk categories, including healthcare workers, lab personnel, and individuals with known exposure to the virus.
- The Government may announce mass vaccination campaigns in regions with increased case numbers.

4. Hygiene and Sanitation Practices

- Wash hands frequently with soap and water or use alcohol-based hand sanitizers.
- Avoid touching the face, particularly eyes, nose, and mouth, with unwashed hands.
- Maintain proper sanitation in public places, particularly in transportation hubs, healthcare settings, and markets.

5. Use of Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)

- Healthcare workers, caregivers, and individuals in contact with confirmed or suspected MPOX patients must wear appropriate PPE, including gloves, masks, and face shields.
- The public is encouraged to wear face masks, especially in crowded areas, to reduce the risk of transmission.

6. Travel and Movement Restrictions

- Avoid non-essential travel to regions with high MPOX transmission rates. Travelers returning from such areas must undergo a 14-day quarantine and self-monitor for symptoms.
- Public transportation should implement social distancing measures and ensure proper disinfection of vehicles.

7. Public Gatherings and Social Events

- Organizers of large public gatherings such as festivals, sports events, or rallies must ensure compliance with health and safety protocols, including crowd control, mask mandates, and access to hand sanitizers.
- Where possible, limit social interactions and gatherings in enclosed spaces to minimize the risk of spreading the virus.

8. Veterinary and Wildlife Guidelines

- Veterinarians and animal handlers should wear gloves and protective clothing when handling animals suspected to carry the virus.
- Avoid direct contact with wildlife, particularly rodents and non-human primates, in regions with confirmed MPOX outbreaks.

9. Education and Public Awareness

- The Government will launch campaigns to raise awareness about MPOX, including its symptoms, transmission, and prevention measures.
- Schools and workplaces must educate students and employees on personal hygiene and infection prevention protocols.

10. Enforcement of Guidelines

- Authorities are empowered to enforce compliance with isolation, quarantine, and other safety measures. Violators may be subject to fines or legal actions under public health laws.

11. Support for Affected Individuals

- The Government will provide financial and medical support to individuals affected by MPOX, including free testing, treatment, and quarantine facilities.
- Mental health support services will be made available to individuals undergoing isolation or quarantine.

